

# William O'Neill

Site Reliability Engineering (SRE) Leader

Atlanta, GA

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## Summary

Staff Site Reliability Engineer driving high-impact infrastructure and platform engineering strategy across cloud platforms, observability, and reliability engineering. Known for cost-efficient architecture decisions and owning reliability strategy across multi-team, production-scale environments, improving operational clarity and enabling scalable systems through automation and standardization.

## Work Experience

### Vantage

New York, NY (remote)

Staff Site Reliability Engineer

August 2025 - Current

- Defined and led reliability strategy for stateful and platform infrastructure, defining standards for observability, incident response, and operational excellence across engineering teams.
- Drove modernization of stateful infrastructure, including zero-downtime PostgreSQL (Postgres) 13 to 18 upgrades via blue/green deployments, eliminating ~\$7K/month in support costs and establishing a repeatable upgrade model.
- Improved production signal fidelity and SLO adherence by aligning AWS ALB and application layer error handling, reducing false positives and improving on-call effectiveness.
- Established observability standards adopted across services and engineering teams that differentiate infrastructure and application failure modes, using Datadog to reduce MTTR and improve system diagnosability.
- Identified systemic gaps in Cloudflare AI Gateway logging and metering, restoring data integrity for customer-facing analytics and implementing forward-compatible ingestion fixes.
- Influenced cost and vendor strategy through targeted improvements in observability usage efficiency and Datadog contract optimization.
- Drove cross-team platform strategy across major platform initiatives, including ECS to EKS migration, Terraform standardization (Infrastructure as Code), and DNS/VPN reliability improvements, aligning with long-term scalability and operability goals.
- Introduced and scaled the use of architecture decision records (ADRs) and operational runbooks, improving cross team alignment, reducing ambiguity in production operations, and enabling more autonomous engineering execution.
- Shaped operational best practices that reduced reliance on tribal knowledge, improved incident response consistency, and increased overall engineering velocity.

### SurveyMonkey

San Mateo, CA (remote)

Senior Engineering Manager - Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)

August 2022 - May 2025

- Led a three-year cloud migration and platform transformation to a scalable Kubernetes-based platform (K8S) supporting 200+ services and ML workloads, replacing an overprovisioned static setup.
- Migrated and refactored 200 services, 30 ML models, and 100 libraries/SDKs with zero-downtime.
- Reduced compute costs by 40%+ (~\$2M annually).
- Reduced secrets sprawl by streamlining Hashicorp Vault policies and ensuring that local development environments were configured to use the same policies.
- Built, led, and mentored a high-performing team of six engineers delivering core platform infrastructure, fostering collaboration and innovation.

Staff Software Engineer - Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)

October 2021 - August 2022

- Designed and implemented automation frameworks, eliminating manual toil and boosting CI/CD efficiency.

### ReCharge Payments

Santa Monica, CA (remote)

Senior DevOps Engineer

June 2020 - October 2021

- Implemented CI/CD pipelines for Terraform and Ansible, accelerating peer review cycle time by 60% (from 2-3 days to under 1 day).
- Created standardized Terraform stacks, enabling self-service infrastructure and reducing platform team dependency.
- Designed an interactive candidate tech lab as an additional vetting process during the team's interview cycle.
- Improved individualized developer testing environments by implementing Let's Encrypt SSL certificates and OAuth based authorization.

### Teachers Pay Teachers

New York, NY (remote)

DevOps Tech Lead

December 2018 - June 2020

- Led the transition from a generalist operations team to a Cloud Operations-focused infrastructure model.
- Drove improvements to processes so that requests from development teams were fulfilled in a consistent manner. These changes enabled the Cloud Operations team to implement SLOs for most common requests.
- Led PCI Level 1 certification efforts, reducing audit time from multiple weeks to just 2 days.
- Developed reusable Terraform modules that encapsulated best practices for AWS infrastructure automation.

## Spreadly

Senior Systems Engineer

Durham, NC (remote)

May 2017 - November 2018

- Ensured Spreadly's PCI Level 1 card vault status by introducing security compliance tooling as part of the build and deployment process.
- Transitioned deployments from manual bespoke processes to immutable infrastructure as code via Ansible, Packer, and Terraform.
- Active contributor to the open source [DevSec Hardening Framework](#) project.

## GE Digital

Lead Infrastructure Automation Engineer

Atlanta, GA

August 2016 - May 2017

- Improved automation of the wing to wing monitoring of GE's network and compute assets. Consolidated monitoring tool sprawl by creating business unit dashboards.
- Automated microservices lifecycle deployment using Jenkins, Sphinx, Swagger, and Ansible.
- Developed an easy button application for the first contact helpdesk which empowered them to do tasks such as pinging hosts, check on application status, and even reboot machines with supervisor approval.

## MailChimp

Senior Infrastructure Engineer

Atlanta, GA

October 2012 - May 2016

- Spearheaded migration from 3rd party managed hosting to self-managed colocation data centers.
- Scaled and influenced the growth of the infrastructure organization from 3 to 40 engineers, driving documentation, training, and mentorship.
- Migrated high traffic DNS domains from a provider that billed based on usage to Akamai. This reduced costs since billing was no longer traffic based and increased the SLA for DNS.
- Consolidated hundreds of domain names spread across several registrars to one registrar. This made management of domain names more consistent, provided visibility into domain names that should be added or dropped as necessary, and enabled creation of a customized 'parked page' for unused domains.
- Subject matter expert for DNS (internal and external), server provisioning and Akamai CDN configurations.
- Developed internal tooling that automatically provisioned servers from 'rack and stack' bare metal to a fully installed OS registered with an in house CMDB. Same tooling was also used to handle kvm based virtual provisioning.
- Implemented configuration management using Puppet, replacing an in-house configuration management tool where development had been abandoned.

## Skills

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|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Cloud and Infrastructure</b>      | AWS (Amazon Web Services), GCP (Google Cloud Platform), Kubernetes (K8s), Docker, Terraform, ECS, EKS, VPC, DNS |
| <b>CI/CD and DevOps</b>              | CI/CD, GitHub Actions, ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD, Helm, Infrastructure as Code (IaC), Continuous Delivery   |
| <b>Programming</b>                   | Python, Ruby, Node.js, Shell (Bash)                                                                             |
| <b>Security and Compliance</b>       | PCI DSS, Cloud Security, Infrastructure as Code (IaC), Secrets Management, HashiCorp Vault                      |
| <b>Observability and Reliability</b> | SLOs, SLIs, MTTR, Monitoring, Alerting, Incident Response, Datadog                                              |

## Presentations

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### PAYMENTSfn 2018

Durham, NC

[Raising Children vs Raising Rabbits](#)

May 2018

- A lightning talk about the tooling behind Spreadly's cloud instances and how compliance and security are built into the process.

### GitHub Octotales

[Octotales: MailChimp](#)

March 2016

- GitHub's video profile of MailChimp and their use of GitHub Enterprise. My favorite quote: "As an infrastructure guy, code is our poetry."

### Atlanta Puppet Camp

Atlanta, GA

[Continuous Deployment of Puppet Modules](#)

December 2014

- Presentation about how MailChimp uses a combination of DSL tooling, editor plugins, peer review, and Jenkins to do continuous deployment of puppet modules to their infrastructure.

## Education

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### Temple University

Philadelphia, PA

Bachelor of Arts, Mass Communication